

Food Chains & Food Webs

Use the cue, then fade the cue. Look at the cue card for 60 seconds. Then cover it before answering Round 1. Check the card only after you commit to an answer.

Cue focus	Food chains show one pathway of energy flow, while food webs show many connected feeding pathways; arrows point in the direction energy moves.
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Round 1 - Retrieve It

1. What does a food chain show?

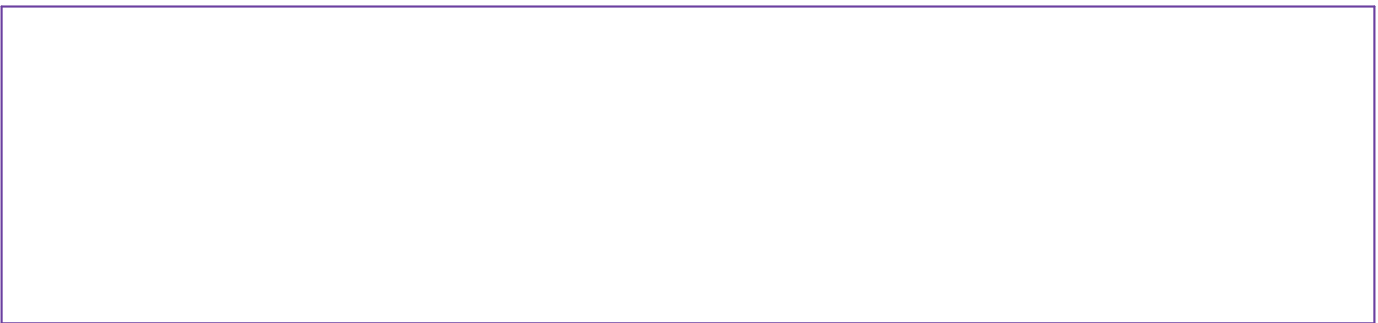
2. What does a food web show?

3. Which direction should an energy arrow point?

4. What is a producer?

Round 2 - Sketch It

Build a food web using grass, grasshopper, rabbit, frog, snake, and hawk. Draw arrows to show energy flow. Include at least five arrows.



Food Chains & Food Webs - Apply It

Keep the cue card covered. Solve first. Then use the cue to check, revise, and explain what you changed.

Round 3 - Apply the Relationship

1. In grass → rabbit → fox, where does the fox's energy ultimately begin?

2. Why is a food web usually more realistic than one food chain?

3. If a producer population drops sharply, which groups may be affected?

Round 4 - Reason from Evidence

A predator disappears from a food web. Explain why predicting the outcome requires considering more than one chain.

Food Chains & Food Webs - ACE It

Use the cue card only if you need it. The goal is to show what you can explain, connect, and use on your own.

A

Articulate

Explain Food Chains & Food Webs in your own words. Use one example that is not printed on the cue card.

C

Connect

Connect food webs to photosynthesis. Why are producers the entry point for most ecosystem energy?

E

Extend

Choose one organism in your drawn web and predict two possible effects if its population is cut in half.

Confidence check Circle one after you finish: I still need the cue / I need it once in a while / I can explain this without it

TEACHER KEY - Food Chains & Food Webs

Remove this page before student copying. Answers below give expected ideas, not required wording.

Retrieve It

1. One pathway of energy transfer through organisms.
2. Many interconnected food chains/feeding relationships.
3. From the organism being eaten/energy source to the organism receiving the energy.
4. An organism that makes its own food, typically using photosynthesis.

Sketch It - look for

Arrows point from food/resource to consumer. Many valid webs exist if relationships are ecologically plausible and arrow direction is correct.

Apply It

1. With the Sun captured by the grass through photosynthesis.
2. Most organisms have multiple food sources and predators, so energy pathways are interconnected.
3. Primary consumers first, then higher-level consumers; effects can spread through the web.

Reason from Evidence - look for

Species have multiple links. Removing one predator can increase some prey, alter competition, affect producers, and shift other predators; web interactions matter.

ACE - Extend look-for

Answers should trace at least two direct or indirect energy/feeding relationships with plausible directions.

Suggested use

Run Page 1 with the cue card available, Page 2 with the cue mostly covered, and Page 3 as independent reflection. Let students uncover the cue to self-correct in a different color or with a revision mark.